



Sony's Google TV remote

Sony has revealed details of its upcoming Google TV remote

In-flight calling?

Singapore airlines is going to introduce in-flight calling and WiFi access in 2011

BEST BUY
digit
NOVEMBER 2010

CELLPHONES

Samsung I5800 Galaxy 3
Price: ₹12,300



Blackberry Pearl 3G 9105
Price: ₹19,900



Fly Ivory
Price: ₹15,499



LG Optimus GT540
Price: ₹12,900



SPECIFICATIONS

Display: 3.2-inches, 16 million colours, 240 x 400 pixels; CPU: ARM 11 667 MHz; RAM: 256 MB; ROM: 512MB; Expansion: microSD; Camera: 3.15 megapixel; Battery: 1500mAh; Weight: 109 g

Display: 2.25-inches, 256K colours, 360 x 400 pixels; CPU: 624MHz; RAM: 256MB; Expansion: microSD; Camera: 3.15 megapixel; Battery: 1150mAh; Weight: 93.6 g

Display: 3.2-inches, 262K colours, 240 x 400 pixels; CPU: ARM920T; ROM: 512MB; Expansion: microSD; Camera: 2.0 megapixel; Battery: 1200 mAh; Weight: 125 g

3.0-inches, 256K colours, 320 x 480; CPU: 600 MHz; RAM: 156 MB; Expansion: microSD; Camera: 3.15 megapixel; Battery: 1500 mAh; Weight: 115.5 g

TEST CENTRE RATINGS (All Scores out of 10)

Features 7.0
Performance 7.0
Build Quality 7.0
Value for money 8.0

Features 6.0
Performance 7.0
Build Quality 7.5
Value for money 6.0

Features 5.5
Performance 6.5
Build Quality 6.0
Value for money 6.0

Features 7.0
Performance 6.5
Build Quality 8.0
Value for money 7.5

WE SAY

7.0

Impressive features like remote file-sharing and media playback, real-time news and stock updates, MS-Office compatible bundled office suite and hassle-free access to online storage account through thinkfree.com. At ₹12,300, it's great buy if you can overlook its low-battery life and ordinary loudspeaker quality. Running Android v2.1, it truly incorporates a powerful user interface, well complemented by the ARM processor.

6.5

At ₹19,900, The Blackberry Pearl 3G 9105 is quite expensive. Although, the touch-sensitive optical track-pad is a saving grace for the phone, it does not compare well with the Samsung Galaxy 3 and LG Optimus GT540. It was a decent performer across all the tests and were not able to find any chinks in its armour. Though the phone is very well thought out, the price leaves a lot to be desired. Look at Nokia before you buy this phone.

6.0

The Fly Ivory lacks many features and is an average performer. Slightly overpriced at ₹13,999, it lacks the subtle user-friendliness of an Android OS or Bada OS. Build quality is cheap as well. Touchscreen is not that responsive even with the stylus. There is nothing much to offer in terms of quality applications except for the data encryption tool. Overall, the Fly Ivory leaves a lot to be desired to earn some respect in this price category.

7.0

The LG Optimus GT540 incorporates a neat and well-organized menu interface, that is aptly complemented by the feature-rich Android operating system and a very responsive touch-screen UI. It is a decent performer with an impressive video playback quality being the super-highlight of the product. The GPS based navigation guide and the popular Google Maps add value for money. Overall, it makes a good buy at ₹12,990.

Buying guide - Cellphones

You want	We Suggest	Price range
A large capacitive touch screen with a full QWERTY hardware keypad	Motorola Droid (Milestone), also look out for the upcoming HTC Desire Z	₹25,000 (Motorola Droid) - ₹31,000 (Desire Z)
The biggest display you can get	HTC Touch HD2, Samsung Galaxy S, Sony Ericsson XPERIA X10	₹28,000 - ₹31,000
Full QWERTY keypad, but on a compact device	Sony Ericsson XPERIA X10 Mini Pro	₹16,000
Best display around, I want to use this for movies	HTC Desire	₹28,900
No touch screen for me, I want a good QWERTY though	Nokia E72	₹16,000
Sleek smartphone around ₹20,000	Samsung Wave S8500	₹20,000
The best camera phone around	Nokia N8	₹26,259
The most fluid touch display, and the best on screen keypad	Apple iPhone 3GS	₹32,000 - ₹41,500 (8 GB, 16 GB, 32 GB are options)